

Icons are yet another Desktop element. Icons are small pictures representing documents, programs, and other things. On the sample desktop, you can see icons for two hard drive partitions (named Q1 and Q2), a RAM Disk (named RAM5), a 3.5" disk (System.Disk), and an AppleShare network volume (DATA.SERVER). There's also a Trash can, which is used for removing things from the Finder desktop. Additionally, the Q1 window contains even more icons, representing documents and programs on the hard drive.

Finally, find the small arrow in the lower left hand corner of the screen. This is the pointer (or cursor). When you move the mouse, this small arrow moves correspondingly on the screen. You use the pointer to select icons, manipulate windows, and choose items from pull-down menus. In fact, our very next chapter is all about using the mouse—so stay tuned!

### ▲ **By The Way...**

The elements of the Desktop (windows, icons, menus, and pointer) happen to form an acronym—WIMP. The term was originally coined by expert computer users who actually resented the simplicity of graphic user interfaces like the Apple Desktop. These folks were used to typing commands—and they liked it! These days, the term WIMP is used in a merely descriptive fashion to refer to programs or computers that use a graphic user interface.